

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager for observability and infrastructure platforms.*

Positioning, ten years shipping data platforms, analytics products, and infrastructure tooling – now applying that stack to Akamai's observability portfolio.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

Dear Akamai Observability Team,

Observability products live at a precise point of tension: the customer using them is almost always in distress – an alert fired, a latency spike appeared, something broke – and the product has to be fast enough, clear enough, and precise enough to help them recover before the problem compounds. Building for that user under that condition requires the same discipline I applied at Rohde & Schwarz, where I was responsible for audit trails, data provenance, and transparent evaluation pipelines for a multimodal AI platform in a government defence programme. The engineer running diagnostics at 2 a.m. and the ML researcher needing reproducible data lineage are solving different problems, but they share the same demand: the system must tell the truth clearly and without noise.

At the Federal Employment Agency I owned an analytics platform – the Arbeitsmarktmonitor – from ETL through to the dashboard layer. I introduced Dagster for automated indicator generation, migrated legacy infrastructure to Kubernetes, standardised CI/CD, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer. That role required exactly the combination Akamai describes: understanding the data flow deeply enough to spec it correctly, and communicating clearly enough with non-technical stakeholders that governance decisions actually landed. I also did the less glamorous work: deprecating old modules, aligning on compliance boundaries, and keeping delivery moving when the operational surface was larger than the team could cleanly own.

Portfolio rationalisation is one of the harder PM responsibilities because it asks you to take something away rather than add something new. At Emil Group I inherited an InsurTech platform where a 17-person team had accumulated technical debt and delivery chaos in equal measure. I split the team into smaller Scrum units with clear ownership, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops. Several module consolidations happened as a direct consequence of that structural reset. The

experience taught me that EOL and rationalisation work is as much about stakeholder sequencing and honest communication as it is about product strategy.

On the technical side, I am fluent enough in the stack to read infrastructure diagrams, reason about trade-offs in data pipelines, and write acceptance criteria that engineers do not need to reinterpret. At Rohde & Schwarz I unblocked an OpenShift infrastructure issue independently – a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year – and delivered it in one week. That kind of hands-on fluency is what lets a PM write precise PRDs rather than vague ones, and it is what I would bring to defining requirements for metrics ingestion, alerting logic, and API surface decisions at Akamai.

I would like to learn more about the current state of the observability portfolio – specifically where consolidation work is already in flight and where customer feedback is pointing most clearly. I am available for a conversation at your convenience.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
